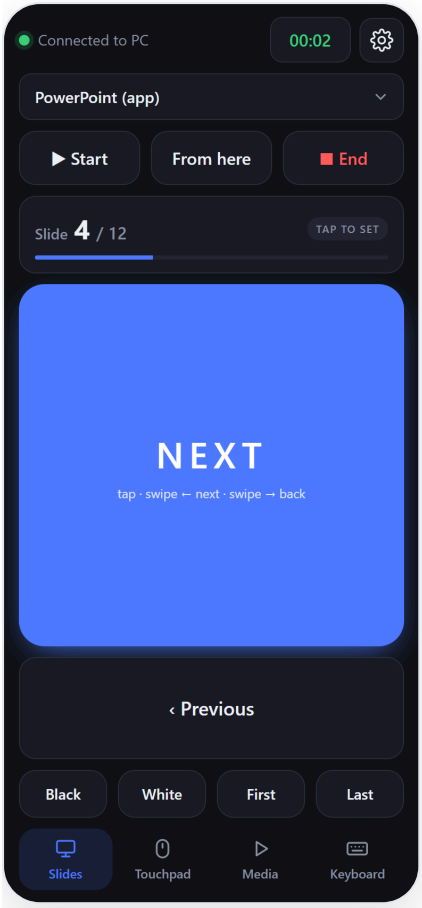
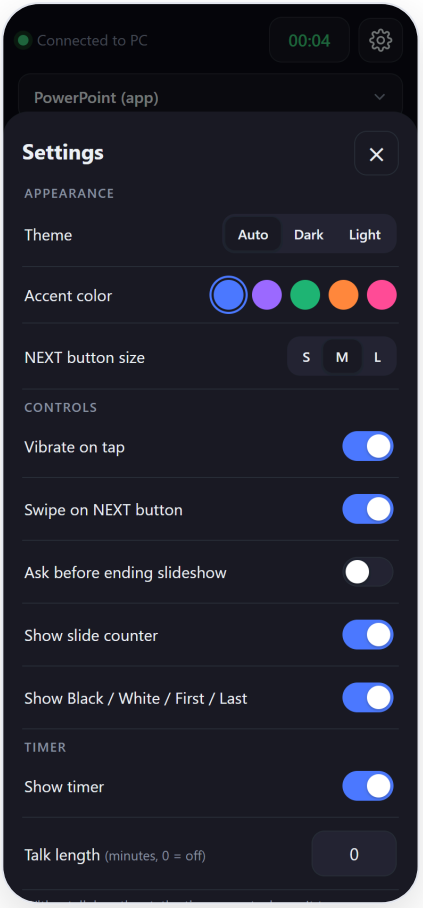
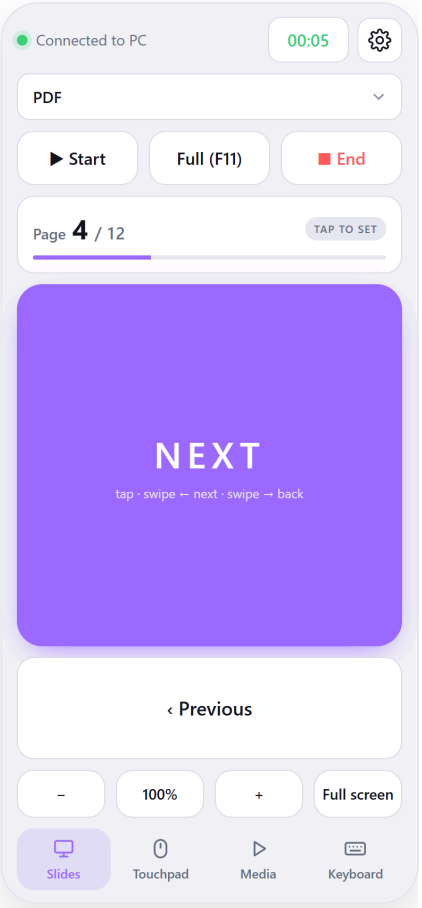
Phone Clicker

Turn your phone into a wireless presentation clicker for PowerPoint, Google Slides, Keynote, PDFs, videos and more.







What's inside

1. How it works
2. Installing
3. Starting and connecting
4. Passcode and security
5. Giving a presentation
6. The Slides tab
7. The slide number
8. The Touchpad tab
9. The Media tab
10. The Keyboard tab
11. Settings
12. App-by-app guide
13. Presenting tips
14. Troubleshooting and FAQ

By Yashwanth Nagaraju · MIT License

1. How it works

Phone Clicker has two parts:

📱 Your phone
A web page in any browser. Nothing to install.

→

📶 Same Wi-Fi
A private, direct link with a secret token

→

💻 Your laptop
A small program that presses keys and moves the mouse

When you tap **NEXT** on your phone, the laptop program presses the `→` key for you, exactly as if you'd pressed it on the laptop's keyboard. That's why it works with almost every app: PowerPoint, Google Slides, PDF readers, YouTube, Canva and more.

What you need

Item	Details
A laptop	Windows 10/11 (64-bit), a Mac with Apple Silicon (M1 or newer), or Linux (X11 session)
The app	A free download. Python and everything else it needs are built in
A phone	Any phone with a web browser (Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Samsung Internet)
Same network	The phone and laptop on the same Wi-Fi. A phone hotspot works too

The four tabs at a glance

🎯 Slides
Start, move through and end a slideshow, with the slide number and a timer. You'll use this tab most of the time.

🖱️ Touchpad
Your phone becomes a mouse, for clicking links, playing embedded videos or opening files mid-talk.

🎵 Media
Play/pause, volume, full screen, zoom and switch app, for videos, music or zooming into details.

⌨️ Keyboard
Type on your phone and the text appears on the laptop, for searching or typing a URL from across the room.

> **Private by design.** Every time Phone Clicker starts, it makes a new secret link. Only phones that scanned *that* QR code can control your laptop. Everything stays on your local network, and nothing is sent over the internet.

2. Installing

You only need to do this once per laptop. You **don't need Python** or anything else, because the app comes with everything built in.

Download

Go to the project's **Releases** page on GitHub (`github.com/its-yashwanth-n/phone-clicker/releases`) and download the file for your laptop:

Laptop	File	What it is
Windows	`PhoneClicker-Setup-x.y.z.exe`	Installer (recommended)
Windows, no install	`…-windows-portable.zip`	Unzip and run `PhoneClicker.exe` , even from a USB stick
Mac	`…-macos-apple-silicon.dmg`	Disk image for M1/M2/M3/M4 Macs
Linux	`…-linux-x64.tar.gz`	Unpack and run `PhoneClicker/PhoneClicker`

Windows

1. Run **PhoneClicker-Setup-x.y.z.exe**.
2. If Windows shows **"Windows protected your PC"**, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. This appears because the app isn't code-signed yet. It's safe and only happens once.
3. Click through the installer. It doesn't need admin rights, and you can tick **Create a desktop shortcut**.

Mac

1. Open the **.dmg** and drag **Phone Clicker** into **Applications**.
2. The first time you open it, macOS says it can't be opened because the app isn't notarized. Go to *System Settings* → *Privacy & Security*, scroll down and click **Open Anyway**. On older macOS versions, right-click the app and choose **Open**.
3. Allow it to press keys: *System Settings* → *Privacy & Security* → *Accessibility*, then turn on **Phone Clicker**.

Linux

```
tar -xzf PhoneClicker-*-linux-x64.tar.gz
./PhoneClicker/PhoneClicker
```

Uninstalling

Windows: *Settings* → *Apps* → *Installed apps* → *Phone Clicker* → *Uninstall*. **Mac:** drag the app from Applications to the Bin. **Linux / portable:** delete the folder. Nothing else is left behind.

Developers (or Intel Mac users) can also run it from the Python source code. See "Running from source" in the README.

3. Starting and connecting

Open Phone Clicker

Laptop	How to open
Windows	Start menu → **Phone Clicker**, or the desktop shortcut
Mac	Applications → **Phone Clicker** (or search for it with Spotlight)
Linux	Run `./PhoneClicker/PhoneClicker`

Allow it the first time

- **Windows Firewall** pops up and asks about Phone Clicker. **Tick "Private networks" and click Allow.** If you skip this, your phone can't connect.
- **macOS** blocks key presses until you turn on Phone Clicker in *System Settings → Privacy & Security → Accessibility*.

Connect your phone

1. **First time only:** the laptop page asks you to **create a 4–8 digit passcode** (see section 4).
2. The page shows a big **QR code**. Open your phone's **camera**, point it at the code, and tap the link that appears.
3. **Type your passcode** on the phone's keypad and tap ✓.
4. The remote opens. Check that the top-left says ● **Connected to PC** (or Mac) with a **green dot**.

> **Keep Phone Clicker running** while you present. To stop it, close the console window (Windows/Linux) or click **Stop Phone Clicker** on the QR page (any laptop). The link changes every time you restart it, so scan again after a restart. If you open the app while it's already running, it just shows the QR page again.

If the dot is red

The phone shows **"Reconnecting..."** and dims the buttons whenever the connection drops, and it reconnects on its own as soon as it can. If it never turns green, see **section 14, Troubleshooting**.

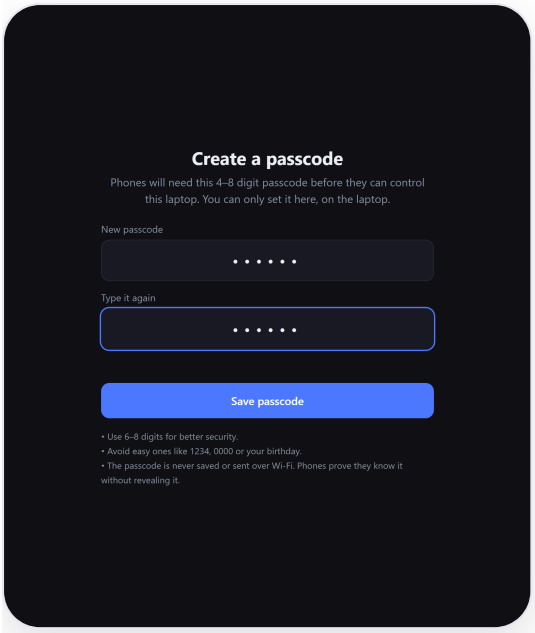
Optional: command-line options

```
PhoneClicker --port 9000      # use a different port
PhoneClicker --no-browser     # don't open the QR page on the laptop
PhoneClicker --version        # show the version
```

4. Passcode and security

Phone Clicker can press keys on your laptop, so nobody gets in without your passcode, and it takes care not to show secrets on a projector.

Creating your passcode (first start)

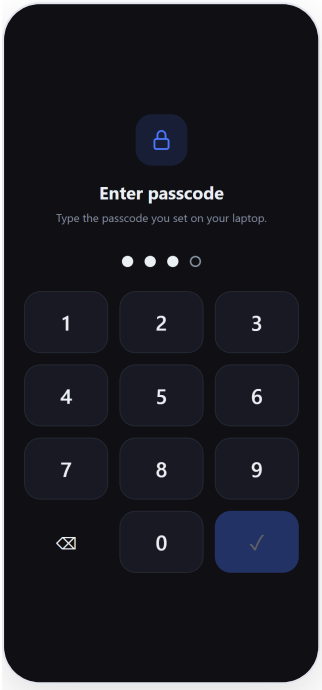


The laptop page on first start

- Choose **4 to 8 digits**. 6–8 digits are safer.
- Easy codes like **1234**, **0000** or **9876** are refused.
- You can **only set it on the laptop**. Phones and other websites can't set or change it.
- The QR code doesn't appear until a passcode exists, so no phone can ever connect without one.
- **Never sent, never saved:** the phone proves it knows the passcode using **SRP**, a challenge-response protocol. The digits never cross the Wi-Fi, and the laptop stores only a one-way "verifier".

Changing it: click **Change passcode** on the laptop page and enter the current one first. Every connected phone is logged out and must enter the new passcode.

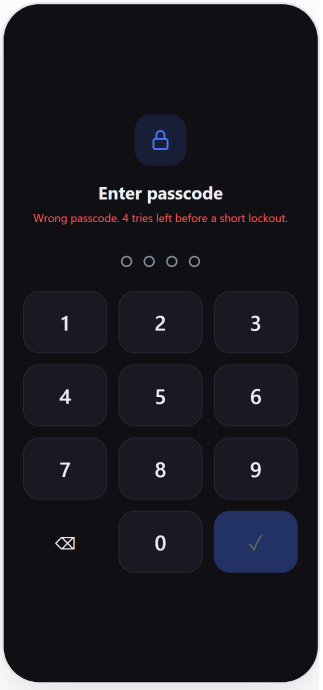
Entering it on the phone



Keypad

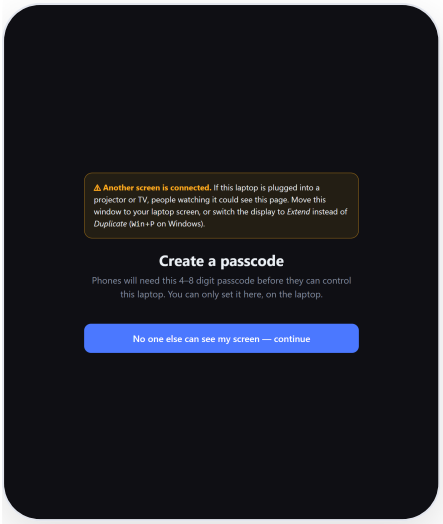
After scanning the QR code, the phone shows a keypad. The remote stays locked until the passcode is right, and the digits only ever show as dots.

Wrong passcode	The dots shake and it shows how many tries are left
5 wrong tries	That phone is locked out for 30 s, then 1, 2, 4… up to 15 minutes
20 wrong tries	From any phones within 5 minutes: everyone is locked out for 5 minutes
Refresh or screen lock	Reconnects without asking again, until the app restarts



Wrong passcode

Projector and second-screen safety



Another screen connected

When you present, your screen may be mirrored to a projector or TV. Phone Clicker detects extra screens and takes precautions:

- **Warning banner** whenever another screen is connected.
- **Passcode forms hidden** until you click "*No one else can see my screen — continue*".
- **QR code blurred** while another screen is connected, and as soon as a phone connects. Click **Show QR code** to reveal it. It hides itself again after a minute.
- **Masked typing:** the passcode only appears as dots, on the laptop and the phone.
- **Nothing in the console:** the console window never shows the QR code or link.
- The secret link is **removed from the phone's address bar** after it opens.

> **Best practice:** set your display to **Extend**, not Duplicate (`Win` + `P` on Windows, *System Settings → Displays* on Mac), and keep the Phone Clicker page on your own screen.

Safe on Wi-Fi

Passcode never sent	The phone answers a fresh random challenge using SRP (RFC 5054). Someone recording the Wi-Fi learns nothing they could use to guess the passcode offline. Every guess has to go to the laptop, where the lockout applies.
No replays	Each login and reconnect uses a new challenge, so recorded messages can't be reused. The key that lets a phone reconnect is worked out on both sides and never transmitted.
Secret link	A 192-bit random token, new on every start.

> **Limits:** after you unlock, button presses travel unencrypted. Someone on the same Wi-Fi could see *which* buttons you press, but can't take control or learn your passcode. A skilled attacker actively intercepting the network could still interfere, so use your own Wi-Fi or your phone's hotspot for important talks.

Forgot your passcode?

Close Phone Clicker and delete its settings file, then start it again to create a new one. On Windows it's `%APPDATA%\PhoneClicker\config.json`. On a Mac it's `~/Library/Application Support/PhoneClicker/config.json`. On Linux it's `~/.config/phone-clicker/config.json`.

5. Giving a presentation

1. On the laptop, **open your presentation** (or PDF) and **click on it once** so it's the active window.
2. On the phone, choose your app from the dropdown at the top, for example **PowerPoint (app)**.
3. Tap ▶ **Start**. The slideshow starts full screen and the timer starts counting.
4. Tap the big **NEXT** button to go forward. Tap ‹ **Previous** to go back.
5. Glance at the **slide number** card to see where you are, and the **timer** to see how long you've been talking.
6. Tap ■ **End** when you're done. The timer pauses.

> **The golden rule:** Phone Clicker presses keys in **whichever window is active** on the laptop. If you tap NEXT and nothing happens, someone probably clicked another window. Click your presentation once and carry on.

Swipe gestures

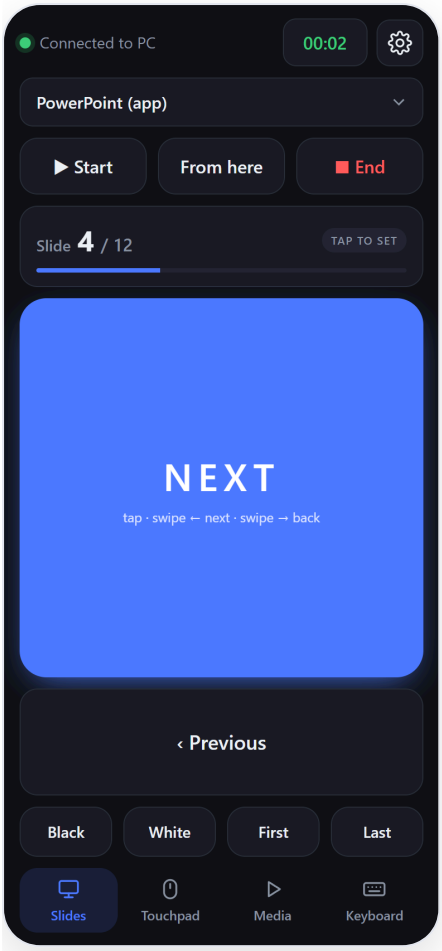
Gesture on the NEXT button	Result
Tap	Next slide (or next animation)
Swipe left ←	Next slide
Swipe right →	Previous slide

You can turn swiping off in Settings if you find yourself swiping by accident.

Presenting from a PDF

Choose **PDF** in the dropdown. NEXT and Previous then use `Page Down` / `Page Up`, which work in every PDF reader. **Start** enters Adobe Acrobat's full-screen mode (`Ctrl` + `L`). **Full (F11)** makes your browser (Chrome or Edge) full screen. The bottom row becomes **zoom −, 100%, zoom +** and **Full screen**.

6. The Slides tab



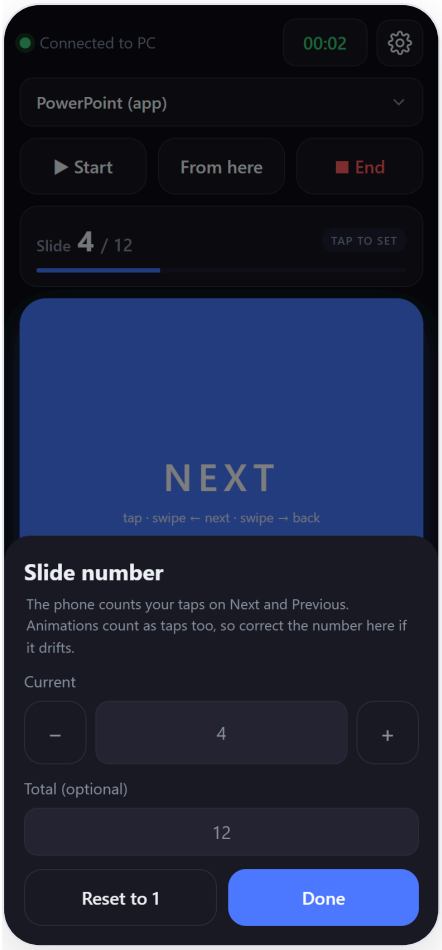
Slides tab in PowerPoint mode

This is the main screen. It has everything you need to run a talk.

Control	What it does
● **Connected**	Green means you're connected to the laptop. Red means it's reconnecting
00:00	The talk timer. Tap to start or pause, double-tap to reset. See Settings to set a countdown
⚙	Opens Settings
App dropdown	Tells Phone Clicker which app you're using, so Start sends the right shortcut
▶ Start	Starts the slideshow from the first slide, and starts the timer
From here	Starts the slideshow from the slide currently selected on the laptop
■ End	Exits the slideshow (`Esc`) and pauses the timer
Slide 4 / 12	Where you are in the deck. Tap it to correct it (see section 7)
NEXT	Next slide or animation. It's big so you can hit it without looking
‹ Previous	Back one slide or animation
Black	Blacks out the screen, which pulls the audience's attention to you. Tap again to come back
White	Turns the screen white, which is handy as a "whiteboard" pause
First / Last	Jump straight to the first or last slide, for example to your Q&A slide

> **Why is "From here" missing?** Some apps (PowerPoint for the web, and Keynote on Mac) have no keyboard shortcut for it, so the button hides itself.

7. The slide number



Tap the slide card to adjust it

The card above NEXT shows the current slide, the total, and a progress bar, so you always know how far through your talk you are.

Live mode: PowerPoint on Windows

When you use the **PowerPoint (app)** profile on a Windows laptop, Phone Clicker reads the slide number **directly from PowerPoint**. A badge shows where the number comes from:

Badge	Meaning
LIVE	The slideshow is running and the number comes from PowerPoint. It's always correct, even with animations, hidden slides, or if someone uses the laptop keyboard
EDITING	PowerPoint is open but not presenting. It shows the slide selected in the editor
TAP TO SET	Counter mode (below)

Counter mode: all other apps

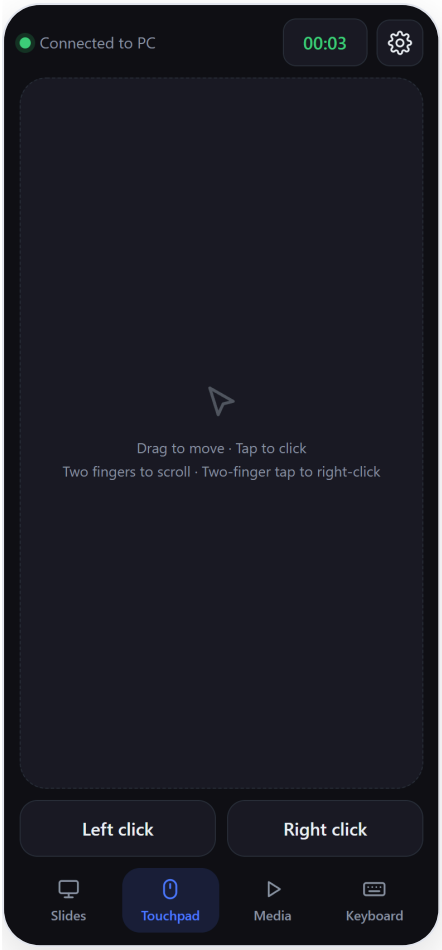
For Google Slides, PDFs, Keynote and others, the phone **counts your taps**: NEXT adds one, Previous subtracts one, and Start and First reset it to 1.

Tap the card to open the **Slide number** panel:

- **Current:** use − and +, or type a number, to fix it.
- **Total:** enter how many slides your deck has. This turns on the "/ 12" display and the progress bar, and stops the count going past the end.
- **Reset to 1:** start the count again.

> **Animations:** in counter mode, each animation step counts as a tap. If your slides have lots of animations, the count can run ahead. Just tap the card and correct it.

8. The Touchpad tab



Touchpad tab

This turns the big panel into a laptop-style trackpad, so you can control the mouse from anywhere in the room.

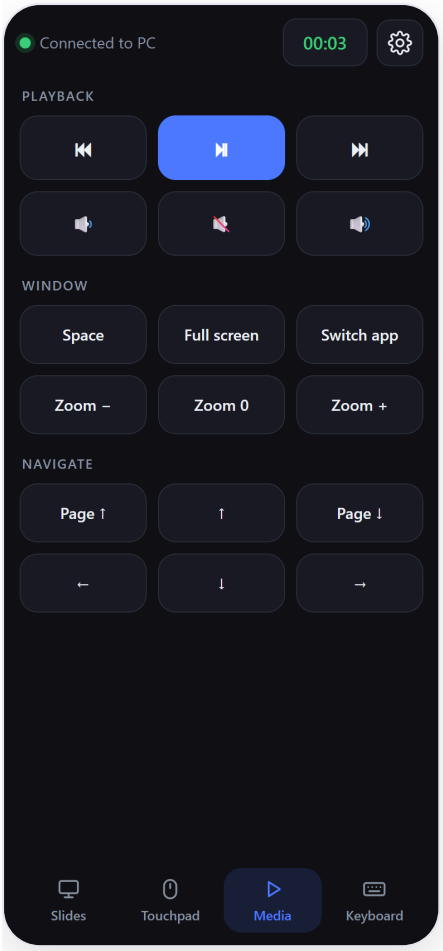
Gesture	Action
Drag one finger	Move the mouse pointer
Tap	Left click
Drag two fingers	Scroll up or down
Two-finger tap	Right click
Left / Right click	Buttons for precise clicks without tapping the pad

When is this useful?

- Clicking a **link** or **play button** on an embedded video inside a slide
- **Opening a file** or switching to another document during your talk
- **Scrolling a web page** or a long document while you explain it
- Pointing at something on screen: the mouse pointer works as a simple laser pointer

Change the **pointer speed**, **scroll speed** and **natural scrolling** direction in Settings.

9. The Media tab



Media tab

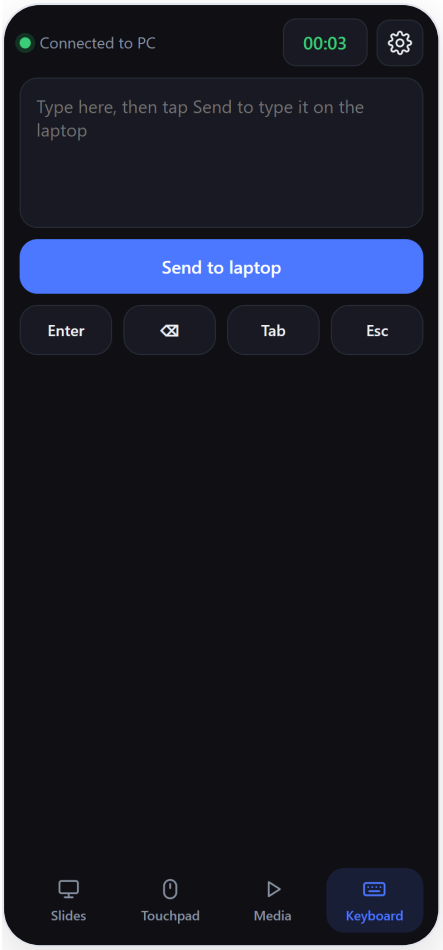
The media keys and handy shortcuts, grouped into three sections.

Button	What it does
Playback	
⏮ ⏯ ⏭	Previous track, play/pause, next track. Works with Spotify, YouTube, Windows Media Player and most browsers
🔉 🔇 🔊	Volume down, mute, volume up for the whole laptop
Window	
Space	Play/pause in YouTube, Netflix and most video players
Full screen	`F11`. Browser full screen
Switch app	`Alt` + `Tab` (`⌘` + `Tab` on Mac). Jump to the last app you used
Zoom − / 0 / +	Zoom out, reset, or zoom in (`Ctrl` + `−` / `0` / `=`)
Navigate	
Page ↑ / ↓	Scroll a page at a time
Arrows	The four arrow keys

When is this useful?

- Playing a **video** during your talk and controlling the volume from the stage
- **Zooming in** on a chart, spreadsheet or code so the back row can read it
- Jumping between your slides and a **live demo** with Switch app

10. The Keyboard tab



Keyboard tab

Type with your phone's keyboard and send the text to the laptop.

1. Tap the text box and type (voice dictation works too).
2. Tap **Send to laptop**. The text is typed wherever the laptop's cursor is.
3. Use **Enter**, ⌫ **Backspace**, **Tab** and **Esc** for the keys you'll need next.

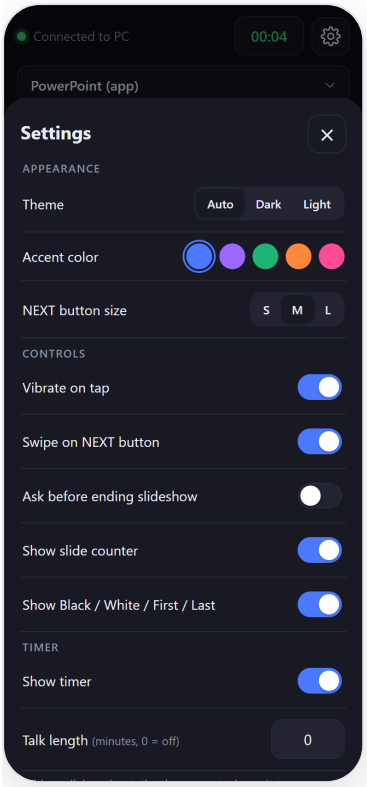
When is this useful?

- **Searching** for something the audience asks about, without walking back to the laptop
- Typing a **website address** into the browser
- Filling in a **sign-in or search box** during a demo
- Adding a quick note to a document while discussing it

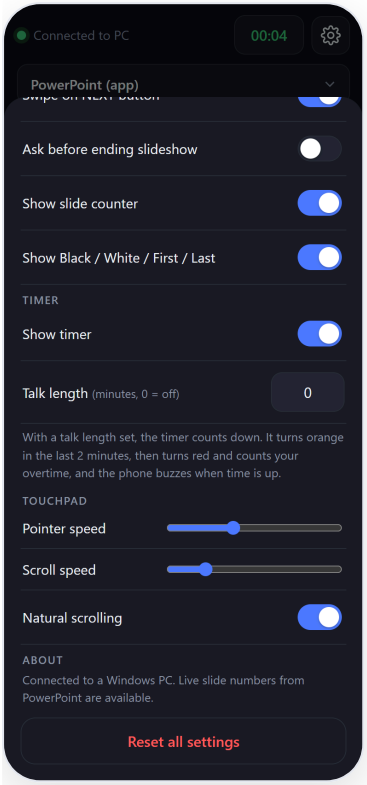
> Tip: click into the right box on the laptop first (or use the Touchpad tab to click it), then send your text.

11. Settings

Tap the ⚙ **gear** in the top-right corner. Changes apply immediately and are saved on your phone, so they're still there next time.



Appearance and controls



Timer, touchpad and about

Appearance

Theme	**Auto** follows your phone's dark/light mode. Or force **Dark** (best in dim rooms) or **Light**
Accent color	Blue, purple, green, orange or pink, for the NEXT button and highlights
NEXT button size	**S**, **M** or **L**. Smaller leaves more room. Larger is easier to hit without looking

Controls

Vibrate on tap	A short buzz confirms each press (Android. iPhones don't allow web pages to vibrate)
Swipe on NEXT	Turn swipe gestures on or off. With it off, any touch on NEXT means next
Ask before ending	Shows "End the slideshow?" before ■ End, to stop accidental exits
Show slide counter	Hide the slide number card if you don't need it
Show Black / White…	Hide the bottom row for a cleaner screen

Timer

Show timer	Show or hide the timer in the top bar
Talk length	Set your time slot in minutes. The timer **counts down**, turns **orange** in the last 2 minutes, turns **red** and shows your overtime (e.g. **+01:20**) when you run over, and the phone buzzes when time is up. Set it to 0 to count up instead

Touchpad

Pointer speed	How far the mouse moves for each finger movement
Scroll speed	How fast two-finger scrolling moves
Natural scrolling	On: content follows your fingers, like a phone. Off: the classic mouse-wheel direction

About

Shows what you're connected to and whether live slide numbers are available. **Reset all settings** restores the defaults.

12. App-by-app guide

Pick the matching option in the dropdown so **Start** and **From here** send the right shortcut. NEXT and Previous use the arrow keys, which work in all of these apps.

App (dropdown)	Start	From here	Notes
PowerPoint (app)	F5 Mac: ⌘⇧↩	Shift + F5 Mac: ⌘↩	Live slide numbers on Windows
PowerPoint (web)	Ctrl + F5	–	office.com in your browser
Google Slides	Ctrl + Shift + F5 Mac: ⌘⇧↩	Ctrl + F5 Mac: ⌘↩	Works in Chrome, Edge, Firefox
Keynote	⌥ + ⌘ + P	–	Shown only when connected to a Mac
PDF	Ctrl + L / ⌘ + L Acrobat full screen	F11 / ^ + ⌘ + F Browser / Preview	NEXT/Previous use Page Down/Up

Other apps

Anything that moves forward with the arrow keys works too. Pick **PowerPoint (app)** and use NEXT and Previous, then start full screen yourself on the laptop:

- **Canva** presentations, **Prezi**, **Pitch**, **reveal.js** and other HTML slide decks
- **Photo viewers** (Windows Photos, macOS Preview) for slideshows of pictures
- **Video players**: use the Media tab

13. Presenting tips

- **Test before your talk.** Connect, tap Start, and click through a couple of slides in the actual room.
- **Turn off your phone's auto-lock** (or set it to 10 minutes) while you present. Web pages can't keep the screen awake without HTTPS.
- **Use a phone hotspot** if the venue's Wi-Fi is a guest network. Connect the laptop to your phone's hotspot and everything works offline.
- **Set a talk length** in Settings so the timer warns you before you run over.
- **Use Black** to pull attention back to you during discussions, and tap it again to return to your slides.
- **Keep the laptop plugged in** so it doesn't go to sleep during a long Q&A.
- On PowerPoint for Windows, **use the live slide number** to check your pace. The progress bar shows how far through you are.

14. Troubleshooting and FAQ

The phone can't open the page, or the dot stays red

- Check that the phone and laptop are on the **same Wi-Fi**. Turn off mobile data on the phone to be sure.
- **Guest, hotel, school and office Wi-Fi** often block devices from talking to each other. Use your phone's hotspot instead.
- **Windows Firewall:** open *Windows Security → Firewall & network protection → Allow an app through firewall*, find **Phone Clicker**, and tick **Private**. Also make sure your Wi-Fi is set to *Private* (not Public) in Windows network settings.
- Make sure the Phone Clicker window is still open on the laptop.

Green dot, but nothing happens on the laptop

- Click on your presentation so it's the active window.
- Check that the dropdown matches the app you're using.
- **macOS:** allow Accessibility access (section 3).
- **Linux:** log in with an **X11/Xorg** session. Wayland blocks simulated key presses.

Start doesn't start the slideshow

Some browsers and laptops (especially ones with an `Fn` key) grab certain shortcuts. Start the show by hand on the laptop. NEXT and Previous will still work.

The slide number is wrong

In counter mode, animations count as taps. Tap the slide card and correct it. On Windows with PowerPoint, pick the **PowerPoint (app)** profile to get live, always-correct numbers.

"Windows protected your PC" or "can't be opened" on Mac

This happens because the app isn't code-signed yet. On Windows, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. On a Mac, go to *System Settings → Privacy & Security* and click **Open Anyway**. You only need to do this once.

"Port already in use"

Another program is using port 8765. Close it, or start Phone Clicker with `--port 9000`.

Do other people need to install anything?

On their phone: no. It's just a web page. **On their laptop: just the Phone Clicker app.** It's a normal installer with no Python or anything else to set up. Each presenter runs it on the laptop they're presenting from, because only a program running on that laptop can press its keys. Several phones can connect to the same laptop at once, which is handy for co-presenters.

Is it safe?

Yes. Phones need both the secret link from the QR code (new on every start) **and** your passcode. Wrong guesses trigger lockouts, the passcode can only be set on the laptop, and the QR code hides itself while a projector is connected. Nothing leaves your local network. See section 4.

I forgot my passcode

Close the app, delete its `config.json` settings file (see section 4), and start it again to create a new passcode.